



KIFT 2026 @ GOETHE-INSTITUT

SEPTEMBER 3 (THUR) 2026

2:00 - 5:00 PM

DIALOGUE OF FASHION-TECH ENTHUSIASTS

KIFT

When Fashion Meets Digital Technology

Chiara
Moderator

Emilia
Bocconi University

Kel Bang
GIANTSTEP

Valeria Volponi
Istituto Marangoni

Kima Kim
CaliWise

Ludovica Lancioni
Atelier Stagotti

SJF
SILK JOURNAL FOUNDATION



KIFT

KIFT 2024 at Museo Nazionale Scienza e Tecnologia Leonardo da Vinci in Milan

KEY THEME

AI COUTURE - REIMAGINING FASHION THROUGH INTELLIGENCE

WHERE GERMAN EXCELLENCE MEETS CREATIVE INNOVATION

- Hosted at the Goethe-Institut Korea, KIFT 2026 explores how **AI is transforming the future of fashion**—from design and manufacturing to sustainability, retail, and brand experiences.
 - Drawing **inspiration from Germany's culture of excellence and global leadership in industrial innovation and craftsmanship**, KIFT 2026 will serve as a platform connecting Korean and German innovators, fashion-tech enthusiasts, researchers, and young entrepreneurs.
 - Fashion is **entering a new era where creativity is increasingly augmented by AI**. AI is no longer simply a tool for efficiency. It is becoming a collaborator in every walk of creativity.
 - Sungjoo Foundation (in connection with **MCM, celebrating its 50th anniversary, Fashion Council Germany, hosting its 2nd showcase in Seoul**) wants to partner with Goethe-Institut.
-

PROGRAM

THE GERMANY-KOREA AI FASHION FORUM

A FLAGSHIP CONFERENCE FEATURING TOP GERMAN BRANDS, FASHION-TECH LEADERS

- **Time:** September 3 (Thursday), 2026 14:00 to 17:00 (TBD)
 - **Location:** Veranstaltungssaal @ Goethe-Institut Korea
 - **Program:** 3 panel discussions (12 to 15 expert panels from top German, Korean fashion-tech leaders) followed by Q&A and network reception to create a further dialogue.
 - **Audience:** Young professionals, entrepreneurs, researchers and students in fashion-tech fields
 - **Co-Hosts:** Goethe-Institut Korea x Fashion Council Germany x Sungjoo Foundation (MCM)
 - Goethe-Institut will **support with the venue, content evaluation and promotion** to German-Korean.
 - Fashion Council Germany will bring **key German talents** such as fashion editors and designers.
 - SUNJOO Foundation will **bear the cost for KIFT production, PR, catering & live streaming.**
-

PANEL 1: AI IN DESIGN

The Creative Co-Pilot

Generative artificial intelligence is shifting the design paradigm from pure craftsmanship to highly augmented collaborative curation—empowering human creators to explore unprecedented design spaces.

CONCEPT EXPLORATION

Generative Concepts & AI-Assisted Design

Rapid Iteration: Brands like **adidas** are transitioning design cycles from months to days. Generative adversarial networks (GANs) interpret trend data and athlete insights to output high-fidelity conceptual directions instantly.

Creative Laboratories: Elite German design schools and creative AI labs are piloting algorithms that blend archival brand silhouettes with modern, biomechanically optimized geometry.

STRATEGIC IMPACT:

Explores novel design permutations structurally impossible via manual methods.

PROTOTYPING & TRENDS

Digital Twins & Virtual Prototyping

Zero-Waste Sampling: **Hugo Boss** leverages virtual prototyping and 3D modeling environments to virtually draft, drape, and test fabrics before a single physical thread is cut.

Trend Forecasting: Machine learning pipelines scan global runway feeds, social sentiments, and localized search query indices to accurately predict color palettes and silhouette lifecycles 18 months in advance.

STRATEGIC IMPACT:

Slashes material prototype waste by over 70% during initial review cycles.

SPEAKERS TO BE DETERMINED SOON.

THERE IS A ROOM TO INVITE/CHANGE EXPERTS UPON GOETHE-INSTITUT'S REQUEST TO ADVANCE GERMAN-KOREA CULTURE EXCHANGE.

PANEL 2: AI IN FASHION-TECH VALUE CHAIN

Industry 4.0 Meets Apparel

| Merging German manufacturing excellence with state-of-the-art apparel robotics to forge responsive, highly resilient localized smart factories.



Networked Smart Factories

At the core of Industry 4.0 is cyber-physical networking. Factories like **Hugo Boss's Izmir Facility** employ fully connected machinery that feeds real-time production analytics into algorithmic dispatch systems.

Allows immediate reassignment of factory lines based on real-time assembly bottlenecks.



Predictive Robotics

Historically, textile limpness resisted robotic manipulation. Next-generation sewing robotics use optical sensors and AI tension adaptation to dynamically adjust needle speeds, preventing textile slippage in real-time.

Combines German sensor engineering with high-speed Korean physical execution mechanics.



Demand Forecasting

Moving from pushed mass-production to pulled on-demand replenishment. Decision Intelligence platforms (e.g. o9 Solutions) continuously reconcile consumer data, slashing safety stock, overstocks, and transport overheads.

Empowers brands to achieve sub-10% deadstock margins across volatile product lines.

SPEAKERS TO BE DETERMINED SOON.

THERE IS A ROOM TO INVITE/CHANGE EXPERTS UPON GOETHE-INSTITUT'S REQUEST TO ADVANCE GERMAN-KOREA CULTURE EXCHANGE.

PANEL 3: AI IN CIRCULAR ECONOMY

Intelligence for a Circular Fashion Economy

Leveraging German environmental leadership and machine-learning frameworks to satisfy evolving global ESG mandates and design circular product loops.

VALUE CHAIN PHASE	AI-POWERED CAPABILITY	STRATEGIC PARTNER / TECHNOLOGY
Recycling & Sorting	Automated Fiber Separation: Near-infrared (NIR) spectral cameras coupled with deep-learning classifiers identify raw fiber compositions in real-time, instantly sorting post-consumer waste for mechanical or chemical separation.	FRAUNHOFER SOCIETY
Supply Chain Traceability	Immutable Digital Product Passports: Automated tracing engines map textile lineage from farm to retail floor. Real-time ledger queries ensure regulatory and chemical compliance under the EU Corporate Sustainability Due Diligence Directive.	OSAPIENS
Carbon & Scope 3 Analysis	Predictive Carbon Footprints: Machine learning models analyze raw energy usage and logistics routing across Tier 1, 2, and 3 factories to accurately calculate the lifecycle carbon impact of each garment.	ENVIRONMENTAL AI ENGINES



PANEL CANDIDATES

include

Scott Lipinski (CEO Fashion Council Germany)
Christiane Arp (German Vogue Editor in Chief)
Dirk Schönberger (Global Brand Officer of MCM)
Christopher Han (SAP AppHaus Managing Director)
Mark Lee (MarqVision, CEO)
Simon Kim (CLO Virtual Fashion, CEO)
JeongHyun Kim (Rebuilder AI, CEO)

...

more to come

presented by
Chloe Cho (CNBC)



A photograph of a busy networking reception in a grand, ornate hall. In the foreground, two women are engaged in conversation, both holding glasses of wine. The woman on the left is wearing a dark blazer and a name tag, while the woman on the right is wearing a light-colored blazer. They are surrounded by other guests in formal attire, some holding drinks. The background features large arched windows and a chandelier, creating a sophisticated atmosphere.

NETWORKING RECEPTION
Continuing Dialogue &
Spreading Inspiration

KIFT

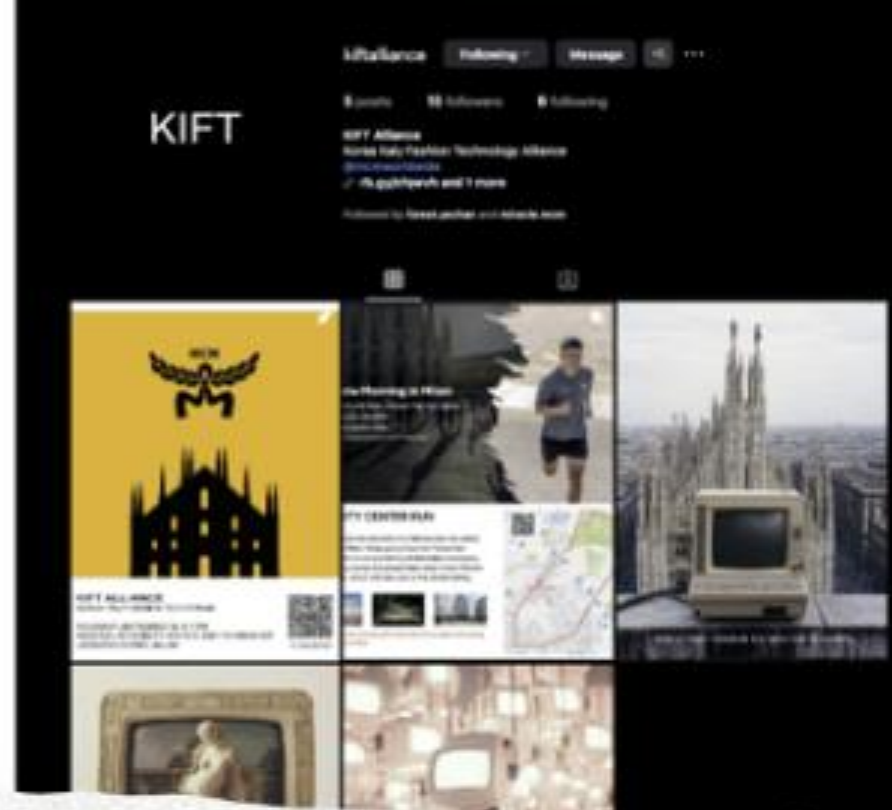
KOREA INTERNATIONAL FASHION TECH

FRIDAY, 5 SEPTEMBER, 2025
2:00 PM – 5:00 PM

WOMANS UNIVERSITY



SCAN TO



REGISTRATION & PROMOTION

- EVENTUS
- SOCIAL MEDIA
- INVITATION MAILING LIST
- SEOUL FASHION WEEK & GOETHE-INSTITUT
- LIVE-STREAMING & POST-EVENT CONTENT

- 
- GOETHE-INSTITUT LEADERSHIP SUPPORT
 - GERMAN-KOREAN ENGAGEMENT
 - BIG ANNOUCEMENT

CALL TO ACTION